

Topic: Eigenvalues and Eigenvectors

Question 1. Let $A = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & -1 \\ 2 & 4 \end{bmatrix}$.

- (a) Find the eigenvalues and eigenvectors of A .
- (b) Verify that the trace equals the sum of the eigenvalues, and the determinant equals their product.
- (c) Consider $B = A + 100I = \begin{bmatrix} 101 & -1 \\ 2 & 104 \end{bmatrix}$. Find the eigenvalues and eigenvectors of B .

Question 2. Find the eigenvalues $\lambda_1, \lambda_2, \lambda_3$ of

$$A = \begin{bmatrix} 3 & 4 & 2 \\ 0 & 1 & 2 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 \end{bmatrix} \text{ and } B = \begin{bmatrix} 0 & 0 & 2 \\ 0 & 2 & 0 \\ 2 & 0 & 0 \end{bmatrix}.$$

Check that $\lambda_1 + \lambda_2 + \lambda_3$ equals the trace and $\lambda_1 \lambda_2 \lambda_3$ equals the determinant.

Question 3. (omitted from AY2023/2024)

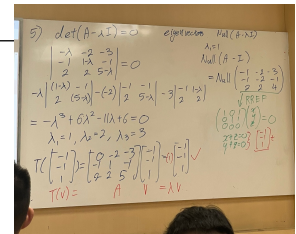
Suppose $\mathcal{V}$ is the real vector space of all real-valued functions $f : \mathbb{R} \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ which have derivatives of all orders. Let $T : \mathcal{V} \rightarrow \mathcal{V}$ be the linear transformation $T(f) = f''$. Determine whether each of the following functions f is an eigenvector of T ? If it is, what is its corresponding eigenvalue?

- (a) The constant function $f(x) = k$, where k is a real nonzero constant.
- (b) The sine function $f(x) = \sin(kx)$, where k is a real nonzero constant.
- (c) The exponential function $f(x) = e^{kx}$, where k is a real constant.
- (d) The exponential function $f(x) = \sqrt[3]{x}$.

Question 4. Consider the following basis $\mathcal{B}$ for $\mathbb{R}^3$ and the linear operator T on the vector space $\mathbb{R}^3$, where

$$\mathcal{B} = \left\{ \begin{bmatrix} 0 \\ 1 \\ 1 \end{bmatrix}, \begin{bmatrix} 1 \\ -1 \\ 0 \end{bmatrix}, \begin{bmatrix} 1 \\ 0 \\ 2 \end{bmatrix} \right\} \text{ and } T \left(\begin{bmatrix} a \\ b \\ c \end{bmatrix} \right) = \begin{bmatrix} 3a + 2b - 2c \\ -4a - 3b + 2c \\ -c \end{bmatrix}.$$

- (a) Verify that every basis vector in $\mathcal{B}$ is an eigenvector for T , and determine its corresponding eigenvalue λ . Here, $\mathbf{v}$ is an eigenvector for operator T if $T(\mathbf{v}) = \lambda \mathbf{v}$ for some value λ .
- (b) What is the matrix representation $[T]_{\mathcal{B}}^{\mathcal{B}}$ of T with respect to the basis $\mathcal{B}$?



Question 5. Given a matrix $\mathbf{A} \in \mathcal{M}_{3 \times 3}(\mathbb{R})$, where $\mathbf{A} = \begin{bmatrix} 0 & -2 & -3 \\ -1 & 1 & -1 \\ 2 & 2 & 5 \end{bmatrix}$.

- Write down the characteristic polynomial of $\mathbf{A}$ and determine all the eigenvalues of $\mathbf{A}$. You may need to recall the cofactor expansion for determinants.
- For each eigenvalue λ of $\mathbf{A}$, find the set of eigenvectors corresponding to λ .
- Find a basis $\mathcal{B}$ for $\mathbb{R}^3$ consisting of eigenvectors of $\mathbf{A}$. Hence, determine an invertible matrix $\mathbf{P}$ and a diagonal matrix $\mathbf{D}$ such that $\mathbf{A} = \mathbf{PDP}^{-1}$. In this case, we say that $\mathbf{A}$ is *diagonalizable*.

Question 6. Consider the linear operator T on the vector space $\mathcal{P}_1(\mathbb{R})$ defined by

$$T(a + bx) = (6a - 6b) + (12a - 11b)x.$$

- Obtain the matrix representation $[T]_{\mathcal{B}}^{\mathcal{B}}$ of T with respect to the standard basis $\mathcal{B} = \{1, x\}$.
- Find all eigenvalues and their corresponding eigenvectors of $[T]_{\mathcal{B}}^{\mathcal{B}}$.
- Let $\mathbf{e}_1 = (a_1, b_1)^T$ and $\mathbf{e}_2 = (a_2, b_2)^T$ be two linearly eigenvectors found in (b). Set $\mathcal{A}$ to be the basis $\mathcal{A} = [a_1 + b_1x, a_2 + b_2x]$. What is the corresponding matrix representation $[T]_{\mathcal{A}}^{\mathcal{A}}$?

Question 7. (omitted from AY2023/2024)

Given a matrix $\mathbf{A} \in \mathcal{M}_{2 \times 2}(\mathbb{C})$, where $\mathbf{A} = \begin{bmatrix} i & 1 \\ 2 & -i \end{bmatrix}$.

- Determine all the eigenvalues of $\mathbf{A}$.
- For each eigenvalue λ of $\mathbf{A}$, find the set of eigenvectors corresponding to λ .
- Find a basis $\mathcal{B}$ for $\mathbb{C}^2$ (as a complex vector space) consisting of eigenvectors of $\mathbf{A}$. Hence, determine an invertible matrix $\mathbf{P}$ and a diagonal matrix $\mathbf{D}$ such that $\mathbf{A} = \mathbf{PDP}^{-1}$.

Question 8.

- Let $\mathbf{A}$ be a square matrix. Prove that $\mathbf{A}$ and its transpose $\mathbf{A}^T$ have the same eigenvalues.
- Let $\mathbf{A}$ and $\mathbf{B}$ be two similar square matrices. Here, $\mathbf{A}$ and $\mathbf{B}$ are *similar* means there is a matrix $\mathbf{P}$ of the same size as $\mathbf{A}$ and $\mathbf{B}$ such that $\mathbf{B} = \mathbf{P}^{-1}\mathbf{A}\mathbf{P}$. Prove that $\mathbf{A}$ and $\mathbf{B}$ have the same eigenvalues.

Question 9.

- A square matrix $\mathbf{A}$ is invertible if and only if $\lambda = 0$ is not an eigenvalue of $\mathbf{A}$.
- Suppose $\mathbf{A}$ is an invertible matrix. If λ is an eigenvalue of $\mathbf{A}$ and $\mathbf{v}$ is a corresponding eigenvector, then $\lambda^{-1} = \frac{1}{\lambda}$ is an eigenvalue of the inverse $\mathbf{A}^{-1}$, and $\mathbf{v}$ is a corresponding eigenvector.

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Question 10. Suppose that $\mathbf{A}$ is an $n \times n$ -matrix with has exactly n eigenvalues (not necessarily distinct), say $\lambda_1, \lambda_2, \dots, \lambda_n$. In this question, for $n \in \{2, 3\}$, we show that

$$\operatorname{tr}(\mathbf{A}) = \sum_{i=1}^n \lambda_i \text{ and } \det(\mathbf{A}) = \prod_{i=1}^n \lambda_i.$$

Recall: $\operatorname{tr}(\mathbf{A})$ denotes the trace of $\mathbf{A}$. You can follow the general strategy to prove for all n .

(a) Let $n = 2$ and $\mathbf{A} = \begin{bmatrix} a & b \\ c & d \end{bmatrix}$.

- (i) Show that the characteristic polynomial is of the form $(ad - bc) - (a + d)\lambda + \lambda^2$.
- (ii) On the other hand, since $\mathbf{A}$ has eigenvalues λ_1 and λ_2 , its characteristic polynomial can be written as $(\lambda_1 - \lambda)(\lambda_2 - \lambda)$. Compare with the expression in (a)(i) to show that $a + d = \lambda_1 + \lambda_2$ and $ad - bc = \lambda_1\lambda_2$.

(b) Let $n = 3$ and $\mathbf{A} = \begin{bmatrix} a & b & c \\ d & e & f \\ g & h & i \end{bmatrix}$.

- (i) Show that the coefficient of λ^2 of characteristic polynomial is $a + e + i$, while the constant term of characteristic polynomial is $\det(\mathbf{A})$.
- (ii) On the other hand, since $\mathbf{A}$ has eigenvalues λ_1, λ_2 and λ_3 , its characteristic polynomial can be written as $(\lambda_1 - \lambda)(\lambda_2 - \lambda)(\lambda_3 - \lambda)$. Compare with the expression in (a)(i) to show that $a + e + i = \lambda_1 + \lambda_2 + \lambda_3$ and $\det(\mathbf{A}) = \lambda_1\lambda_2\lambda_3$.